

Santiago (Tigo) Ponce de León

product design engineer

A designer who ships the code — research and product thinking through to React in production, in service of software that is both useful and pleasurable.

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experience

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Vicino AI UX Engineer Intern

Jun – Aug 2026

Bellevue, WA

 - Designing product experiences across key workflows for an AI-powered video and marketing platform, turning agentic creative concepts into user-centered interfaces.
 - Building front-end UI components in React, bridging Figma designs and production code to accelerate design-to-engineer handoff.
 - Shaping and documenting the platform’s visual language and interaction patterns into a scalable component library used across feature pages.
- 02

PantryPal Digital Product Designer

Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

Chicago, IL

 - Owned end-to-end design of an AI mobile app generating personalized recipes from household ingredients, cutting food waste through intelligent inventory reuse.
 - Led user research across interviews and usability tests, synthesizing findings into design decisions that improved task completion 40% between testing rounds.
 - Shipped a production-ready Figma prototype — wireframes through high-fidelity UI, a documented component library, responsive layouts, and interaction patterns.
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University of Chicago UX Researcher

Nov – Dec 2025

Chicago, IL

 - Ran an empirical study of visual and interaction patterns across six AI-generated recipe web apps to measure interface homogenization.
 - Deployed prototypes via GitHub Pages and authored the paper on how AI models operationalize a statistical consensus of product design convention.
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Next Level Drone Cleaning Founding Visual Designer

Jul – Sep 2025

Kortrijk, Belgium

 - Designed the complete visual identity for an early-stage drone-tech startup from scratch: brand guidelines, logo suite, and collateral across web, print, and pitch.
 - Built the responsive marketing site (nextleveldronecleaning.be) with the founder, plus component libraries that held the team consistent without ongoing design help.

education

- **University of Chicago** B.A. Media Arts & Design and Computer Science

May 2027

Chicago, IL

Coursework: Human-Computer Interaction, Internet Art & Web Design, Branding & Visual Systems

Honors: Spain Foreign Language Acquisition Grant — immersive study in Madrid, Summer 2025

skills

- product

User Research

Wireframing

Interaction Design

MVP Scoping

Usability Testing
- frontend

React

HTML / CSS / JS

Python

C#

Git
- design

Figma

Adobe Creative Cloud
- languages

Spanish — professional working

English — fluent